

Spaces

Overview

A Space is the primary organizational unit of the platform.

Rather than organizing communication around individual chats or groups, the platform organizes communication around Spaces—shared places where people communicate, collaborate, and share information.

A Space represents a real-world relationship or purpose, such as a family, business, friend group, organization, club, project, or event.

Examples include:

- *  Family
- *  ArcInteractive
- *  Photography Club
- *  Church
- *  Friends
- *  Vacation Planning

Every Space has its own members, conversations, media, events, settings, and permissions.

Purpose

Spaces are designed to keep everything related to a group together in one place.

Instead of switching between separate apps or scattered conversations, members can access everything relevant to that Space from a single location.

A Space serves as a digital home for a group.

Core Principles

- * A Space is for groups, not one-to-one conversations.
- * Every Space has an owner and members.
- * Every Space has a unique identity, including a name, emoji, and appearance.
- * Everything inside a Space belongs to that Space.
- * Spaces are private by default.
- * Membership is controlled through invitations and permissions.

Modules

Spaces are modular.

Every Space begins with a small set of core modules and can expand over time.

Current modules include:

- *  General
- *  Photos
- *  Events
- *  Members
- *  Settings

Future modules may include:

- *  Files
- *  Polls
- *  Shopping Lists
- *  Locations
- *  Voice Rooms
- *  Video Meetings
- *  Announcements
- *  Tasks
- *  AI Assistant

Modules allow a Space to grow without overwhelming users with unnecessary features.

What Belongs in a Space

A Space owns all shared information related to its members, including:

- * Conversations
- * Photos
- * Videos
- * Events
- * Shared files
- * Members
- * Roles
- * Permissions
- * AI context
- * Notifications
- * Shared history

Every shared resource belongs to exactly one Space.

Relationship to Pings

Spaces and Pings are intentionally different.

Spaces

- * Group communication
- * Multiple members
- * Organized with modules
- * Shared collaboration

Pings

- * Exactly two people
- * Simple conversations
- * No modules
- * No roles
- * No shared workspace

If users want to collaborate with more than one person, they create a Space rather than expanding a Ping.

Privacy

Spaces are private by default.

Only invited members can access a Space.

Future capabilities include:

- * End-to-end encrypted messaging
- * Encrypted media
- * Invite-only membership
- * Member roles and permissions
- * Expiring invite links
- * Reporting and moderation tools

The server should never require access to decrypted message content.

Design Philosophy

A Space should feel like entering a place rather than opening another chat.

When users open a Space, they should immediately understand:

- * Who belongs there
- * What is happening

* Where conversations, media, and events are located

The experience should be familiar enough for new users while remaining flexible enough to support families, businesses, organizations, and communities.

Product Principle

Everything belongs somewhere.

Shared communication belongs in a Space.

Private one-to-one communication belongs in a Ping.

This distinction is one of the core architectural principles of the platform and should guide all future feature development.